

Decision 001 – Simplicity Wins

Project: Ghostrader

Decision ID: 001

Status: Permanent Engineering Principle

Date: June 28, 2026

Decision

When in doubt, ship the simpler solution.

If two solutions accomplish the same objective, Ghostrader will adopt the one that is simpler to understand, easier to maintain, and faster to deliver.

Why This Decision Exists

Complex software is expensive to build, difficult to test, and harder for users to understand.

Our competitive advantage is not having the most features—it is creating the most useful experience for beginner investors.

Simplicity allows us to:

- Deliver value faster.
 - Reduce bugs.
 - Improve maintainability.
 - Shorten development cycles.
 - Learn from users sooner.
 - Keep the product approachable for beginners.
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Simplicity Rules

Build the Minimum That Delivers Value

Do not build five features when one solves the problem.

Avoid Premature Optimization

Do not engineer for one million users before we have one hundred.

One Problem, One Solution

Every feature should solve a clearly defined problem.

If a feature attempts to solve multiple unrelated problems, break it into smaller pieces.

Prefer Proven Technology

Choose stable, well-supported tools over trendy frameworks unless there is a compelling business reason to do otherwise.

User Experience Over Technical Elegance

The best technical solution is not always the best product solution.

If a simpler workflow helps the user succeed, it takes priority.

The Simplicity Test

Before approving any feature, ask:

1. Is there a simpler way?
2. Would a beginner understand it?
3. Can we build it in the current phase?
4. Will it be easy to maintain?
5. Does it move us toward our mission?

If the answer to any of these questions is "no," reconsider the design.

Examples

Good

- A clean dashboard with three high-value insights.
- One clear AI explanation instead of five competing metrics.
- One reliable data source before integrating additional providers.

Avoid

- Feature overload.
- Unnecessary configuration options.

- Duplicate functionality.
 - Complex workflows that overwhelm beginners.
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Guiding Statement

"Simple scales. Complexity compounds."

Ghostrader will earn user trust by being clear, reliable, and focused—not by offering the longest list of features.

Amendment Policy

This principle may only be changed if a more complex solution is demonstrably required to achieve the mission of Ghostrader or to deliver meaningful customer value.